

THE SOCIETY OF MAYFLOWER DESCENDANTS IN THE STATE OF ALABAMA

CHARTER GRANTED DECEMBER 6, 1952



Bylaws and Policies

Last Amended November 16, 2024

I. NAME:

The name of this Society shall be the “Society of Mayflower Descendants in the State of Alabama”; it is hereafter referred to as “**Society**”.

The name of this document may also be called the “Bylaws” or the “Constitution”

II. OBJECTS:

To perpetuate to a remote posterity the memory of our Pilgrim Fathers.

To maintain and defend the principle of civil and religious liberty, as set forth in the Compact of the Mayflower, “For the glorie of God, and advancemente of the Christian faith, and honor of our countrie”.

To cherish and maintain the ideals and institutions of American freedom, and to oppose any theories or actions that threaten their continuity.

To transmit the spirit, the purity of purpose and steadfastness of will of the Pilgrim Fathers to those who shall come after us, an undiminished heritage of liberty and law.

To promote the interests that are common to all the Member Societies of Mayflower Descendants which can best be served by a federal body;

To secure united effort to discover and publish original matter in regard to the Pilgrims, together with existing data known only to Antiquarians;

To authenticate, preserve, and mark historical spots made memorable by Pilgrim association.

III. MEMBERSHIP

A. REGULAR MEMBERS:

1. All persons over eighteen years of age who are descended from a passenger on the *Mayflower*, on the voyage which terminated at Plymouth, New England, in December 1620, shall be eligible to membership; and all persons, so descended, who are less than eighteen years of age, shall be eligible for Junior Membership pursuant to Section 8 of this article of the General Society’s Constitution and Bylaws; provided however, (a) that no person shall be eligible for General Society or Member Society membership – regular, junior or life – who is pledged to or advocates, the overthrow, by force or violence, of the Government of the United States, or that of any State or Territory; or who has been guilty of other treasonable practices; or who is not of good moral character; and any Member Society shall have the right to expel from its membership any person for any of these causes; and any question arising under this provisos (a) shall be determined by the affected Society; and provided further (b) that no one may become a member of any Society unless personally acceptable to it. (Adopted September 2017, by the 41st General Congress)
2. Descent by adoption is not recognized.
3. Regular Members shall pay annual dues (See Standing Rules K-3).

B. LIFE MEMBERS:

For the time being Life Memberships have been suspended as of the November 2007 Meeting to be effective January 1, 2008. The following is applicable to current Life Members.

1. Are exempt from payment of annual dues.
2. Life Memberships are not transferable from Member Society to another Member Society.

C. JUNIOR MEMBERS:**1. Eligibility:**

- a. Must be a lineal or collateral descendant of any member in good standing, living or dead, of this Society.
- b. Must be under 18 years of age.
- c. An application must be made indicating lineal or collateral relationship of a member of this Society.
- d. A person may remain a Junior Member until age 25 at which time application can be made for Regular Membership in the Society.
2. To become a Regular Member after age 18 the usual requirements for Regular Membership must be met.

D. HONORARY MEMBERS:

1. Must be a member in good standing.
2. Must be over the age of seventy.
3. Must have been a member of the Society for not less than fifteen (15) years.
4. Must be unable to pay dues.
5. Must make written application to the Society Board of Assistants to be excused from further payment of dues.
6. Must be approved for this status by the Board.
7. The Board shall have the same power, on its own initiative, to award honorary status without the application by such member and may modify the requirements as it deems prudent.

E. FRIENDS OF THE PILGRIMS:**1. Eligibility:**

- a. Must support the principles and goals of the Society of Mayflower Descendants.
- b. Non-lineal or unproven lineage.
- c. Show interest in attending the meetings of the Society.
- d. Be willing to work on educational or similar projects of the Society.
- e. May be a spouse of a Regular Member.
- f. Friends of the Pilgrims are not eligible for office in the Society. They may organize and elect from within their classification for functioning purposes.

2. Dues:

- a. Friends of the Pilgrims shall pay annual dues. (See Standing Rules K-8)
- b. Shall cover the Society's clerical cost of notifying said member and the cost of sending the Newsletter to said member with the remainder

of all dues from said member going to educational purposes of the Society.

F. APPLICATION for Regular Membership shall be initiated in writing on the Preliminary Form furnished by the State Historian or their Assistant.

1. PRELIMINARY REVIEW FORMS:

- a. Must be sent to the State Historian or their assistant for initial review of the lineage for errors or concerns (red flags).
- b. The Mayflower Lineage Match from the General Society may substitute for the Preliminary Review Form should the applicant indicate an intent to apply for membership.
- c. Using the information from the Preliminary Review Form, the State Historian or their Assistant shall request from the General Society a copy of the closest matching application to be cited in the “same as” section of the application (Line Check).
- d. The Historian or their Assistant shall inform the applicant of generations that remain to be proven and the specific required documents needed, such as Birth, Marriage, and Death certificates.

2. LINEAGE PROOF:

- a. It is the sole responsibility of the applicant to provide lineage proof, but the Historian or their Assistant may provide reasonable assistance.
- b. Lineage proof documents shall be submitted to the State Historian within one (1) year of receipt of the Preliminary Review Form. An extension may be granted by the State Historian if deemed advisable.
- c. The State Historian or their Assistant may provide worksheets or application drafts to facilitate communication regarding the proposed application and acceptable documentation provided.
- d. The State Historian or their Assistant shall determine if provided documentation is acceptable for inclusion with the application in accordance with General Society standards.
- e. The applicant must submit payment of all application fees to the Society Treasurer prior to the submission of the application to the General Society.
- f. No refunds shall be made for applications not accepted by the General Society.

3. APPLICATION FOR MEMBERSHIP PAPERS:

- a. Shall be prepared by State Historian or their Assistant in accordance with General Society guidelines.
- b. Shall be signed in black ink by the State Historian or their Assistant and submitted to the General Society once satisfied with the accuracy of the lineage proof and confirmation that fee payment has been received.
- c. Shall be assigned a State membership number upon request by the General Society after General Society approval of the lineage.
- d. Approved applications shall be reported by the State Historian or their Assistant to the Governor and the Board of Assistants after signed by the Historian General and returned to the State Historian.

4. The applicant shall be notified by the Historian or their Assistant of their membership and lineage approval by the General Society and the Society.

This notification shall include a copy of their application signed by the Historian General and a membership certificate.

G. RESIGNATIONS shall be presented to the Secretary in writing and referred to the Board of Assistants for action.

H. DROPPING OF A MEMBER:

1. The Board of Assistants may, by two-thirds vote, drop any member shown to be unfavorably prejudicial to the Society.
2. For non-payment of dues by December 31 (See XIV).
3. For resigning in good standing must be submit their request in writing to the Secretary.

I. REINSTATEMENT:

1. Member who resigned in good standing: Reinstatement shall be by payment of current year's dues.
2. Member dropped for non-payment of dues; (see Standing Rule K-6 b)

IV. TRANSFERS AND SUPPLEMENTALS:

A. A member of another Member Society may apply for transfer by written or e-mail request to the Historian. The transfer may be processed when the applicant has presented the following:

1. A certificate of good standing from the Secretary of the Original Society.
2. A single copy of his or her lineage paper, certified to be a true copy of the original. Certified copies of lineage papers are those are those obtained directly from another Member Society or GSMD containing a Historian General approval signature and GSMD number, usually in pdf or electronic format.
3. A transfer clerical fee approved by this Society. (See Standing Rules K-5)
4. The Society first joined shall retain the original lineage papers.

B. THE HISTORIAN:

1. Shall ascertain the correctness of the papers.
2. Shall assign an Alabama State number.
3. Shall notify the transferee of his or her Alabama number.
4. Shall notify the Historian General within five (5) days of the transfer, and the new State number assigned to the transferee.

C. FEES FOR TRANSFERS TO THE SOCIETY:

1. A clerical charge shall be required. (See Standing Rules K-5).
2. Annual dues to this Society shall start with the year next succeeding that for which dues were last paid to the former Society.

D. FEES FOR TRANSFER FROM THE SOCIETY OR FOR DUAL MEMBERSHIP WITH ANOTHER STATE SOCIETY:

1. A person who wishes to transfer from the Society must have been a member of the Society for one year before a request for transfer may be made.
2. Any additional documentary proof required to accompany lineage papers shall be furnished at its clerical cost.

E. SUPPLEMENTAL LINES:

1. Any member of this Society in good standing who may desire to present Supplemental Lines for approval may do so.

2. Preparation shall follow the process as described in Application for Regular Membership (See III F) with two differences:
 - a. General and State members are to be entered in the proper place and “Supplemental” is to be entered at the top center of the first page.
 - b. The original date of election is to be entered in the proper place.
3. Supplemental lines of a transferee shall be accepted as described in Section IV.
4. In case of any Supplemental Lines not being accepted, no refund will be made.

V. OFFICERS:

Officers of this Society shall be:

Governor
 Deputy Governor
 Secretary
 Treasurer
 Historian
 Elder
 Captain
 Librarian
 Four Assistants (Members-at-Large)
 Deputy Governor General (**DGG**)
 Assistant General (**AG**)

The **Deputy Governor General** and **Assistant General** are Officers of the General Society of Mayflower Descendants and shall be selected by the Society Nominating Committee. It is hoped that these two officers will be able to attend General Society national meetings.

VI. ELECTION OF OFFICERS AND ASSISTANTS

A. Nominating Committee

1. Three members will be proposed by the Governor to be approved by the Board of Assistants at the Fall meeting after the GSMD Congress (or Triannual Meeting).
2. Will prepare nominations for all officers for inclusion in the Spring Newsletter.
3. Will choose its Chair.

B. ELECTIONS:

1. Officers and Assistants of this Society shall be elected by ballot or voice vote at the Annual meeting held after the General Congress.
2. Nominations shall be accepted from the floor for any office, with written approval of the nominee.
3. A majority vote of the members present and voting shall constitute an election.

C. TERM OF OFFICE:

1. The term of office is three years or until their successors are elected.
2. The officers elected shall take up the duties of their office immediately after the meeting at which they are elected.

VII. DUTIES OF OFFICERS:

A. GOVERNOR:

1. Shall preside at all meetings of the Society and of the Board of Assistants.

2. Shall appoint all committees (except the nominating committee) authorized by the State and General Societies.
3. Shall be ex-officio member of all Colonies, Boards, and Committees except the nominating committee.
4. Shall approve and sign all contracts and obligations authorized by the Society or Board of Assistants.
5. Shall approve all disbursements not in the Bylaws or Standing Rules.
6. Shall perform such duties pertaining to the chief officer of the organization as are specified in the parliamentary authority adopted by the Society and in the Bylaws of the General Society

B. DEPUTY GOVERNOR:

1. Shall exercise all the functions of the office of Governor in case of his (or her) absence or disability.
2. Shall be responsible for securing the date, place of meetings, the speaker, and the planning of any meals or refreshments connected with the Society meetings, the table decorations, etc., and shall notify the membership as to the cost. These meetings may be conducted by electronic or virtual means.
3. Shall order the past Governor's medal.
4. Shall perform other duties as assigned

C. SECRETARY:

1. Shall keep accurate records of the proceedings of the Society and Board of Assistants meetings.
2. Shall keep a correct roll of members as of December 31st last preceding, with State and General numbers, names of ancestors and dates of admission.
3. Shall be custodian of the seal and the Charter of the Society and a list of Society property.
4. Shall transmit annually to the Secretary General on or before February 1st a statement giving the total number of Society members as of December 31st last preceding, and any important activities of the Society during the last Society year.
5. Shall transmit to the Historian General, Society Treasurer, and Colony Lieutenant Governors, the Society Membership Changes throughout the year of the names of all new members added, Transfers, Name Changes, Deaths, Dropped, Resigned, Reinstated, and Dual memberships.
6. Shall conduct the correspondence of the Society as assigned.
7. Shall update the directory and make it available to the membership.
8. Shall report to the Secretary General the delegates to the General Congress
9. Shall perform other duties as assigned.

D. TREASURER:

1. Shall take charge of all funds belonging to the Society.
2. Shall keep suitable books of account.
3. Shall charge, collect and receive all fees and dues and all other money payable to the Society.
4. Shall invest with the approval of the Finance Committee all special funds of the Society in accordance with guidelines for 501(c) (3) status.
5. Shall make all necessary disbursements not in the Bylaws or Standing Rules upon the approval of the Governor.

6. Shall report the condition of the Treasury at all meetings of the Society and Board of Assistants and to the Governor at any time either of them may request.
7. Shall send each member notice of annual dues.
8. Shall send to the GSMD from the funds of the Society the payments required by the Constitution and Bylaws of the General Society.
9. Shall, if the Board of Assistants requires it, furnish bond, in excess of the estimated funds in possession at any time, for the faithful handling of the funds, the premium of such bond to be paid from the funds of the Society.
10. Shall complete annually an up-to-date list of members in good standing and send a copy to the Historian, Governor, and Secretary by January 15,
11. Shall complete annually an up-to-date list of each Colony Members in good standing and send it to the appropriate Colony Officers along with check for Colony's Per Capita dues by the end of February.
12. Shall timely submit all 501 (c)(3) filings required by the IRS.
13. Shall perform other duties as assigned.

E. HISTORIAN:

1. Shall examine all Preliminary Review Forms from applicants and Mayflower Lineage Matches from the General Society.
2. Shall request from the General Society a copy of the closest matching application.
3. Shall prepare, sign and give the date of approval of the new and supplemental lineage paper applications.
4. Shall be custodian of all books, papers, or materials used for the duty of the Historian.
5. Shall be custodian of all completed, approved papers returned by the Historian General for filing.
6. Shall prepare and certify copies of lineage papers of members desiring to transfer to another State Society.
7. Shall assign State Numbers to new members.
8. Shall, on receiving a transferee, notify the Historian General within five days of election, the fact of the transfer, the name and the new State number for the transferee.
9. Shall provide electronic copies of approved lineage papers to applicants.
10. Shall issue certificates of membership.
11. Shall mail new members notice of their election and copies of their approved papers.
12. Shall furnish the Secretary and Treasurer with complete information of all new members, approved Supplements, and Transfers.
13. Shall ensure delivery to the Treasurer of all fees and from applicants.
14. Shall perform other duties as assigned.

F. ELDER:

1. Shall lead prayers, read the "Objects of the Society", and "The Mayflower Compact" at all meetings when called upon.
2. Shall conduct memorial services at meetings.
3. Shall conduct such other religious services as occasions may require.
4. Shall send condolences.
5. Shall perform other duties as assigned

G. CAPTAIN:

1. Shall lead the “Pledge of Allegiance to the U.S. Flag” at all meetings when called upon.
2. Shall act as Marshal on all occasions of ceremony.
3. Shall be custodian of the Society Flags and see that they are properly displayed when required.
4. Shall perform other duties as assigned.

H. THE LIBRARIAN:

1. Shall archive historical documents and papers.
2. The records kept by the Librarian are the property of the Society.
3. Shall perform other duties as assigned.

I. DEPUTY GOVERNOR GENERAL:

1. Is a representative of this Society in the General Society’s Board of Assistants and is considered a General Officer.
2. Shall perform duties as described in the General Society’s Constitution and Bylaws.
3. Shall be designated to attend the General Society Board of Assistants meetings and General Congress as described in the General Society’s Constitution and Bylaws.

J. ASSISTANT GENERAL:

1. Is a representative of this Society in the General Society’s Board of Assistants and is considered a General Officer.
2. Shall perform duties as described in the General Society’s Constitution and Bylaws.
3. Shall be designated to attend the General Society Board of Assistants meetings and General Congress as described in the General Society’s Constitution and Bylaws.

VIII. BOARD OF ASSISTANTS:

A. Membership shall consist of:

1. The above officers
2. All former Governors
3. Lieutenant Governors of all Colonies
4. Committee chairs

B. TERM OF OFFICE:

1. The following **shall not** succeed themselves:
Governor
Deputy Governor
2. The other officers may succeed themselves

C. DUTIES OF: Shall have charge of the general direction of the affairs of the Society.

D. VACANCIES:

1. **In the Board of Assistants:**
In its own body and of any office may be filled by the Board of Assistants for the unexpired term with the exception of the office of Governor.
2. **In the office of Governor:**

The Deputy Governor shall immediately succeed to the office and serve the unexpired term, thereby leaving vacant the office of Deputy Governor, the unexpired term of which may be filled by the Board of Assistants.

E. MEETING of the Board of Assistants

1. Shall be no less than twice a year.
2. Shall be at a reasonable date and time prior to the Regular and Annual meetings.
3. Notice shall be no less than one week prior to the meeting.
4. Members must be present to vote; i.e., no proxy votes.
5. These meetings may be conducted by electronic or virtual means provided at least two members of the Board of Assistance are in concurrence. Electronic attendees will be counted toward a quorum.

IX. COMMITTEES:

A. SPECIAL and STANDING COMMITTEES, except the Nominating Committee, shall be appointed by the Governor. They:

1. Shall meet at the call of their chairman.
2. Shall perform such duties as assigned by the Governor.
3. Shall report through their chairman at a regular meeting of the Society, or of the Board of Assistants.

B. STANDING COMMITTEES shall be:

1. **EDUCATION** – will promote knowledge of the Pilgrims, their contributions to the founding of this country, patriotism, and love of God and Country.
2. **FINANCE COMMITTEE** shall consist of Treasurer, Governor, and if deemed advantageous, one appointed by the Governor.
3. **PUBLIC RELATIONS**
 - a. Shall be responsible for getting publicity prior to or following meetings.
 - b. Shall send copies of publicity to the Librarian or to the person keeping historical records.
4. **JUNIOR MEMBERS**
 - a. Shall keep a list of all junior members
 - b. Shall send a certificate to all new junior members.
 - c. Shall communicate with each member at least once a year.

X. MEETINGS:

A. The Society shall hold two meetings each year.

1. The Annual meeting shall be held in the spring of each year and shall be for the purpose of hearing annual reports, election of officers, and any other business to come regularly before the Society.
2. The Regular meeting, celebrating “*Compact Day*”, shall be held in the fall.
3. These meetings may be conducted by electronic or virtual means provided at least two members of the Board of Assistants are in concurrence. Electronic attendees will be counted toward a quorum.

- B. The State Board of Assistants shall have the authority to change the date and place of the meetings of the Society, and of the Board of Assistants. (Suitable dates to be set and members notified in advance).
- C. Special meetings of the Society may be held at any specified time and place at the call of the Governor, or upon written request of ten (10) members. The object of the special meeting must be stated in the notice; members shall be notified of special meetings at least seven (7) days prior to such meetings.
- D. These meetings may be conducted by electronic or virtual means provided at least two members of the Board of Assistants are in concurrence. Electronic attendees will be counted toward a quorum.

E. The Order of Business at all Meetings of the Society shall be:

Call of Order by Governor
 Prayer by Elder
 Reading of Objects and Compact led by Elder
 Pledge of Allegiance to U.S. Flag led by Captain
 Roll Call
 Minutes
 Communications
 Reports of Officers
 Reports of Committees
 Deferred Business
 Election of Officers
 New Business
 Adjournment

F. QUORUM:

- 1. At Regular or Special meetings of the Society, fifteen (15) members shall constitute a quorum for the transaction of business.
- 2. At all meetings of the Board of Assistants, six (6) members shall constitute a quorum.

XI. PARLIAMENTARY AUTHORITY: The Parliamentary authority of this Society shall be Robert's Rules of Order, Revised Current Edition, except when inconsistent with the Bylaws of the General Society.

XII. DELEGATES TO GENERAL CONGRESS: (Refer to General Society Bylaws)

- A. In addition to the two (2) delegates by virtue of office (Deputy Governor General and Assistant General), the number of delegates to the General Congress shall be one (1) Delegate for every fifty (50) members of the Society or majority fraction thereof.
- B. The Society shall be entitled to at least three (3) delegates to the General Congress.
- C. The Governor, or in his or her absence, the Deputy Governor, shall by virtue of his or her office be first delegate to the General Congress. The Governor, after canvassing the Board of Assistants as to who can attend the General Congress, shall appoint all delegates except the first to the Congress.

- D. Delegates by virtue of office are:
Deputy Governor General
Assistant General

XIII. FEES AND DUES:

- A. The fiscal year of the Society shall be from January 1st through December 31st.
- B. The annual dues shall be payable on or before December 31st of each calendar year.
- C. Military personnel in time of active duty are exempt from dues.
- D. Life memberships are not transferable to other State Societies.
- E. Special Assessments shall not be levied except in cases of pressing necessity, and then only by a majority vote of the Society.
- F. Funds shall be budgeted to help defray expenses of the Delegates to the Triennial General Congress and to the General Board of Assistants meetings.
- G. Donations and contributions to this Society are tax deductible.
- H. Dues to the Society are not tax deductible.

XIV. NON- PAYMENT OF DUES:

- A. Any member whose dues remain unpaid by December 31st shall be dropped from the roll, unless otherwise ordered by the Board of Assistants.
- B. To be reinstated as a member of good standing, the member must pay prior and present year's dues plus a reinstatement fee (See Standing Rule K-6b).
- C. If a member does not wish reinstatement but wishes to be considered in good standing, he shall pay the arrears for the year in which he ceased to be a member and his record shall read as having resigned in that year.

XV. DONATIONS:

- A. All donations to be matched by the Society should be sent to the Treasurer and marked to show the donor and the project for which donated. The Treasurer shall send an acknowledgement to the donor.
- B. The Society shall not carry on any activities not permitted to be carried on (a) by an organization exempt from Federal income tax under 501 (c) (3) of the Internal Revenue Code of 1954 (or the corresponding provisions of any future United States Internal Revenue Law), or (b) by an organization, contributions to which are deductible under section 170 (c) (2) of the Internal Revenue Code of 1954 (or the corresponding provision of any future United States Internal Revenue Law).

XVI. INSIGNIA:

- A. May be worn by members on all occasions when they assemble, as such, for any state purpose or celebration, and may be worn on any occasion of ceremony at which they represent the Society.
- B. Shall be worn only as described above and under no circumstances as an article of jewelry.
- C. Shall be worn, when displayed, conspicuously on the left breast with no other emblem above it.
- D. Governor of State Societies, when wearing the special insignia of their office, shall not wear the regular insignia.
- E. Rosettes and buttons may be worn always, except that they may not be worn at the same time with the insignia.

XVII. STATIONERY: The stationery of the Society shall be used only by officers or duly appointed committees of the Society and only for the transaction of business, nor shall

the name of either the General Society or that of the Society, or any part of their official die or device, be used for other than official business. No advertising other than relating to activities of the Society shall appear on official stationery.

XVIII. SEAL: The Seal of the Society shall contain the representations of a sailing vessel of the Seventeenth century and around it the words and figures *“Society of Mayflower Descendants, Plymouth 1620; Alabama 1952”*.

XIX. FLAGS:

- A.** The Flag of the Society shall be the British Jack of the seventeenth century, that is to say, a blue field with a white saltire, known as the cross of St. Andrew on which is superimposed a red cross, fimbriated white, known as the cross of St. George. The whole charged in the center with the seal of the General Society, or of the Society, as the case may be proper. The Flag is to be edged with golden fringe. The pike is to be surmounted by a spearhead. A golden cord and tassels may be suspended from the summit of the pike. The material of the flag shall be silk- like material.
- B.** The flag may be displayed only when accompanied by the Flag of the United States of America of approximately the same dimensions, the pike to be surmounted by an eagle.
- C.** These flags shall be displayed in regulation manner at the Society’s meetings.

XX. COLONIES:

- A.** Ten (10) or more members of this Society, residing in any geographical region of the State of Alabama, may associate themselves as a local colony for social purposes, or for other objects that may promote the interests of the Society. Upon receipt by the State Secretary of a written petition to the Board of Assistants for the authorization for such a Colony, signed by at least ten members residing in such geographical region, and accompanied by a copy of its proposed Bylaws, which in all respects may conform to the provisions of these Bylaws, the Board may, in its discretion, formally authorize such a colony. As amended at the annual meeting on May 24, 1986.
- B.** A local colony shall be known as “The _____ Colony of the Society of Mayflower Descendants in the State of Alabama” according to the name or county in which such colony is formed, or some other appropriate name may be adopted as may be approved by the Board of Assistants.
- C.** No member shall be admitted into a local colony until he has become a member of the Society. Any member who resigns from the Society or is transferred or suspended, or dropped from the roll, thereupon ceases to be a member of a colony

and it shall be the duty of the State Secretary to notify promptly the colony of all cases of resignation, transfer, suspension, or dropping from the rolls, affecting the membership of such colony. The colony once formed may associate with itself, as members thereof, any member of the Society whether resident of its county or not. No member of the Society, residing within the limits of a county in which a colony is formed, shall be excluded from membership in the colony.

- D.** Each colony shall have a presiding officer, to be designated as Lt. Governor, and may choose such other officers as it may desire.
- E.** Each colony may adopt its own Bylaws, Rules, or Resolutions, provided the same, in all respects, conform to these Bylaws and to such Resolutions as the Society may adopt from time to time. No entrance fee shall be required by a colony from any member.
- F.** All members of the Society shall be registered as members of the colony serving the area in which they reside, unless a member expresses, in writing, to the Secretary of the Society that he or she desires to join a different colony, or that he does not desire to be affiliated with a colony.
- G.** Annually a sum of money (20 percent of the Society portion of the annual dues) will be paid by the treasurer to each colony for each member registered to it (per capita reimbursement).
- H.** A member desiring to be registered in more than one colony shall annually pay an additional 20 percent of the annual dues to the State Treasurer for each additional colony membership.
- I.** The minutes of all meetings of each colony shall be transmitted to the State Secretary within thirty (30) days after the holding of such meetings.
- J.** The authorization of any colony and its power to continue may be suspended or revoked by the Board of Assistants for failure to comply with the provisions of these Bylaws or for non-use of the rights and privileges of such colony as defined in this Article.
- K.** If the membership for two calendar years of a colony drops to less than ten (10) members designated as “The _____ Colony of the Alabama Society of Mayflower Descendants”, the colony shall be dissolved with all material, monies, and other assets returned to the Society.
- L.** Members of a dissolved colony will continue as active members of the Society.

XXI. AMENDMENTS:

- A.** These bylaws may be amended at any meeting of the Society by a two-thirds vote of those present and voting, provided notice of the proposed amendment has been sent out fifteen (15) days prior to such meeting, and provided further that the amendment has been proposed by the Board of Assistants or by a committee authorized by the Board of Assistants or by the Society.

- B.** No amendment may be proposed that conflicts with the Constitution or Bylaws of the General Society.
- C.** Any rules or changes adopted by the General Society shall immediately become a law of this Society without notice.

XXII. DISSOLUTION:

- A.** If the membership of the Society on the 31st day of December in any year shall have less than twenty (20) members (living in the state), for two calendar years, the Charter, lineage papers and all other records of the Society shall be surrendered to the Secretary General, and the Society shall be suspended until at least twenty (20) applicants residing in the State, who shall be approved by the General Society, shall ask for re-issue of said Charter constituting such applicants the Society of the Mayflower Descendants in the State, subject to the Constitution of the General Society. (Constitution and Bylaws of the General Society, Article XI, Section 5.)
- B.** This Society may be dissolved by two-thirds vote of the Board of Assistants at any meeting regularly called, or by a majority vote of the general membership upon written ballot, conducted in a manner directed by the Board of Assistants.
- C.** Upon the dissolution by such formal action of the Board of Assistants, or of the membership, or by operation of law or otherwise, the Board of Assistants shall first provide for the payment of all the outstanding debts and obligations of the Society, shall deliver all books, records, genealogical papers of the Society into the care, custody or control of the General Society of Mayflower Descendants and shall turn over all remaining assets to the General Society of Mayflower Descendants if it is then in existence and is tax exempt under Section 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code, but if it does not have such tax exempt status, to some other charitable association having such tax exempt status.
- D.** No fund, assets or moneys shall at any time inure to the benefit of any individual member of the Society, nor shall any such funds, assets or moneys be delivered to or divided up amongst said members at the time of the dissolution of the Society, in as much as the property of this association is irrevocably dedicated to charitable purposes.

XXIII. STANDING RULES:

- A.** State Membership Directories / Yearbooks shall be published electronically at least once per calendar year and shall be made available for download to current Lineage-Certified members in good standing. Updates shall be made available quarterly.”
- B.** The Finance Committee may at its discretion require an internal audit of the accounts of the Treasurer at least every three years.
- C.** The Annual State Meeting may be hosted on a rotating schedule convenient to the various Colonies.
- D.** A sum set by the Board of Assistants shall be available to Colonies hosting the Annual Meeting of the Society.

- E. The Governor's Insignia of Office and Gavel are the property of the Society and will be passed to succeeding Governors.
- F. The past State Governor's Insignia shall be purchased by the Society and presented to the past Governor upon retiring from office.
- G. The sum of no more than \$50.00 shall be available for use by newly formed Colonies to assist them with their organizational expenses.
- H. The Insignia, if purchased by the Society, for the Deputy Governor General and the Assistant General, are the property of the Society, and will be passed to succeeding holders of those positions unless members wish to purchase their own. If they purchase their own, it should be their property unless they choose to donate it to the Society.
- I. Any insignia belonging to the Society that is lost must be replaced by the officer losing it.
- J. That the Society reimburse each official Delegate \$500.00 to cover official expenses for attending the General Society's Triennial Congress Meeting and the General Board of Assistants Meetings.
- K. The fee schedule, net of any transaction fees to process electronic payments, shall be:
 - 1. Application Fee: \$200.00
 - 2. Supplemental Lineage Fee: \$200.00 each
 - 3. Annual Dues: \$5.00 per month, payable annually before 31st December of current calendar year for succeeding calendar year (Total: \$60.00).
 - 4. Life Membership: Suspended at the November 2007 meeting.
 - 5. Transfer to this Society clerical charge: \$15.00
 - 6. Reinstatement:
 - a. A prior member who resigned in good standing can be reinstated by paying the current year's dues.
 - b. A prior member, dropped for non-payment of dues, may be reinstated by paying the prior and present year's dues plus a \$50.00 reinstatement fee. (See XIV: C)
 - 7. Junior membership one-time fee (no annual dues): \$10.00
 - 8. Friends of the Pilgrims' Annual Supporters Contribution: \$2.50 per month, payable annually before 31st December of current calendar year for the succeeding calendar year (Total: \$30.00).
 - a. Upon joining FOTP for the *first time only*, the initial contribution may be prorated by the number of full calendar months remaining in the current calendar year.
 - b. If there are 3 or fewer full months left in the current calendar year, the subsequent year's contribution should be remitted at the same time as the prorated amount for the current calendar year.
 - c. Monies received from FOTP contributions will be shared with the respective Colonies at the same percentage (currently 20%) as are annual Lineage-Certified Members' dues (after paying GSMD their portion).
 - 9. When a person makes payment to the Society for any reason, using a credit or debit card, any processing fee attached to the transaction(s) by

the payment processing service shall be the responsibility of the person making the payment.

- L.** The Standing Rules may be amended at any Board of Assistants meeting.

Constitution/Bylaws Revised November 1991 amended Nov 1994, May, Sep 1999, Nov 2000, Nov 2002, May 2004, Nov 2006, Nov 2007, May 2009, May 2010, Sep 2014. Nov 2015, Oct 2017, Nov 2020, Oct 2023, Nov 2024

List of Colonies by Date of Charter

- **GULF COAST COLONY** – Founded April 26, 1986 – Spanish Fort, Alabama
- **CAPITAL COLONY** – Founded April 7, 1990 – Montgomery, Alabama
- **TENNESSEE VALLEY COLONY** – Founded October 21, 1991 – Madison, Alabama
- **CAHABA RIVER COLONY** – Founded February 18, 2016 – Birmingham, Alabama